

A High-level Guide to Structured Agility

A Systems-Level Guide to Consistency, Flow & Lean Practices

Version 0.01

Overview

Consistency

- “Structured Agility” paradigm.
- Lowers mental / cognitive overhead.
- Promotes “Flow”.

Best Practices

- Principles rooted in lean thinking.
- Balances form with function and aligns with best practices in the industry.

Inter-systems View

- View of the team and project environment through a systems lens.
- Agile <> Hybrid considerations.
- Scaffolds, feedback loops and shared mental models.

Other Guiding Principles

Consistency

Consistency

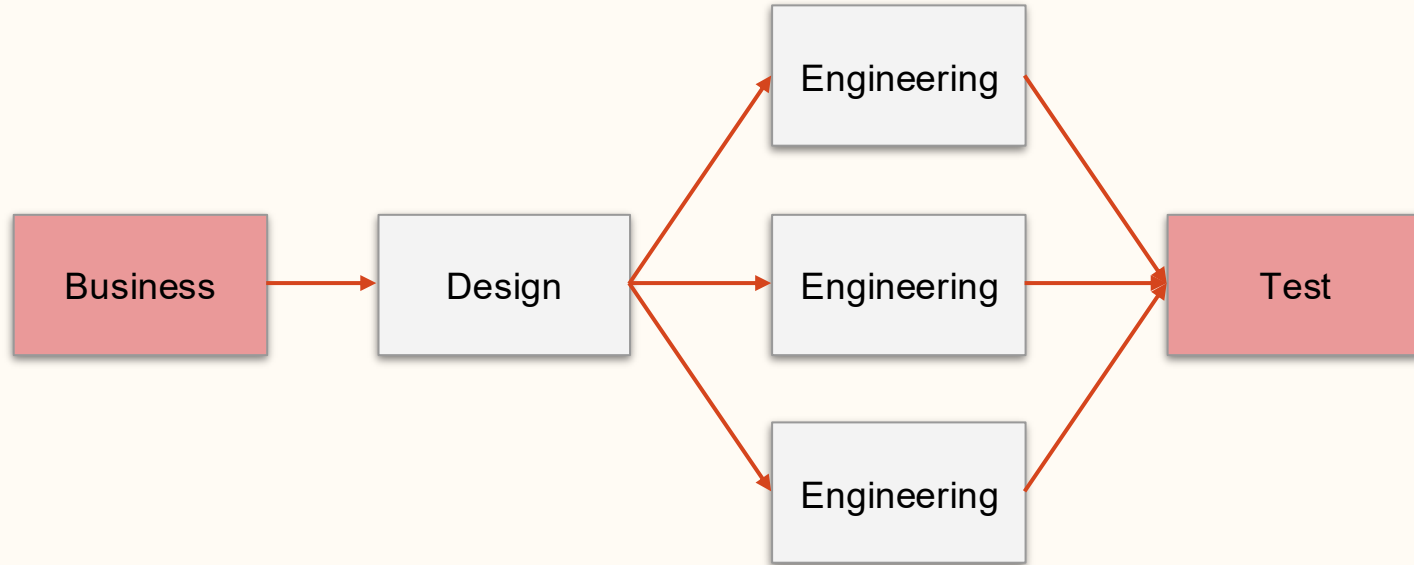
Tickets > Consistent Layout and Formatting

- “Structured Agility” paradigm > Lightweight semi-rigid structures can support agility.
- Structure as the foundation for building shared team mental models.
- Reduces cognitive overheads through “sameness” of layout.

Tickets > Consistent Size

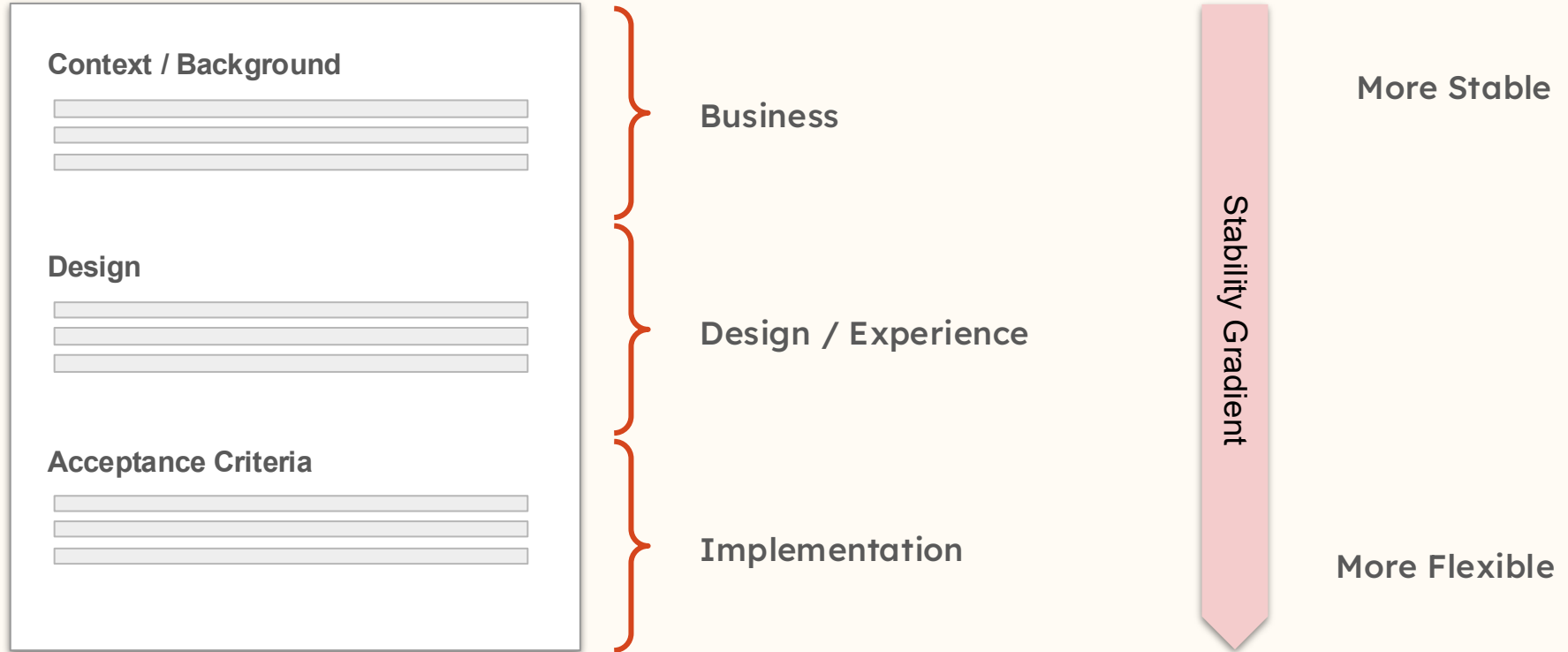
- Work items should be small meaningful to begin work.
- Improves “flow”.

Tickets > Layout Consistency > Promotes Flow



Bottlenecking Risk

Tickets > Layout Consistency



Tickets > Modularised Form

Context / Background

Design

Acceptance Criteria

Business

1. Work on this when ticket is created.
2. Enables early prioritisation by business needs.
3. Organize into epics.

Design / Experience

1. May take business needs as input.
2. Bridge between business (strategy) and implementation).

Implementation

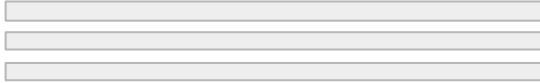
1. Consults with design and business.
2. Work flexibly towards design and business aspirations (i.e. sprint goal).

Stability Gradient

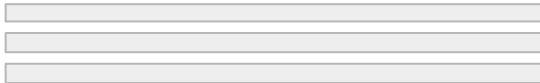
Direction of Work
Refinement

Tickets > Acceptance Criteria Formats

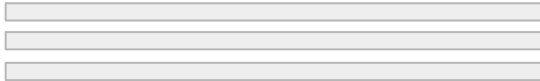
Context / Background



Design



Acceptance Criteria



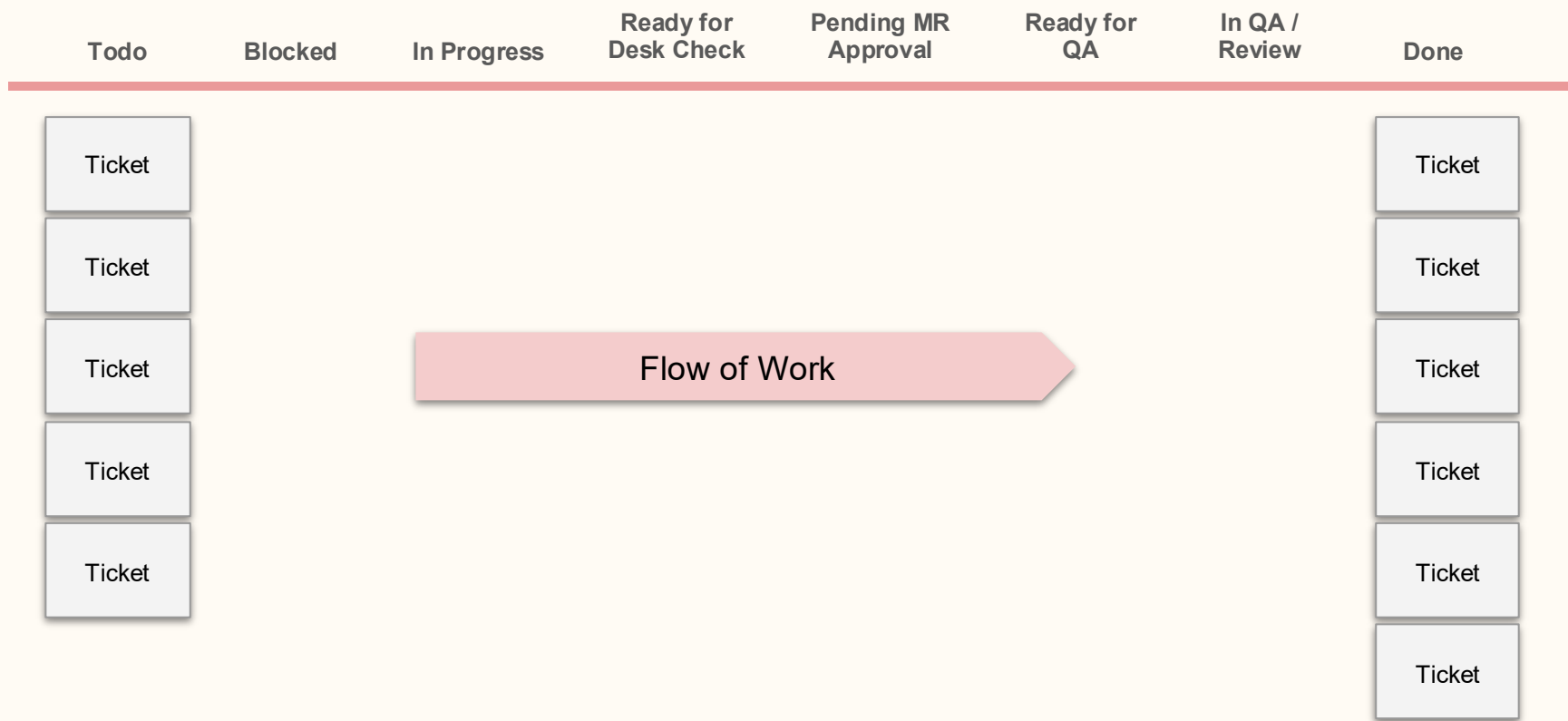
3 Types Explored

1. **Given-When-Then** - Behavior-heavy workflows
2. ***Done-When** - Checklist Format
3. **Tech Tasks** - Similar to Done-When but more lightweight

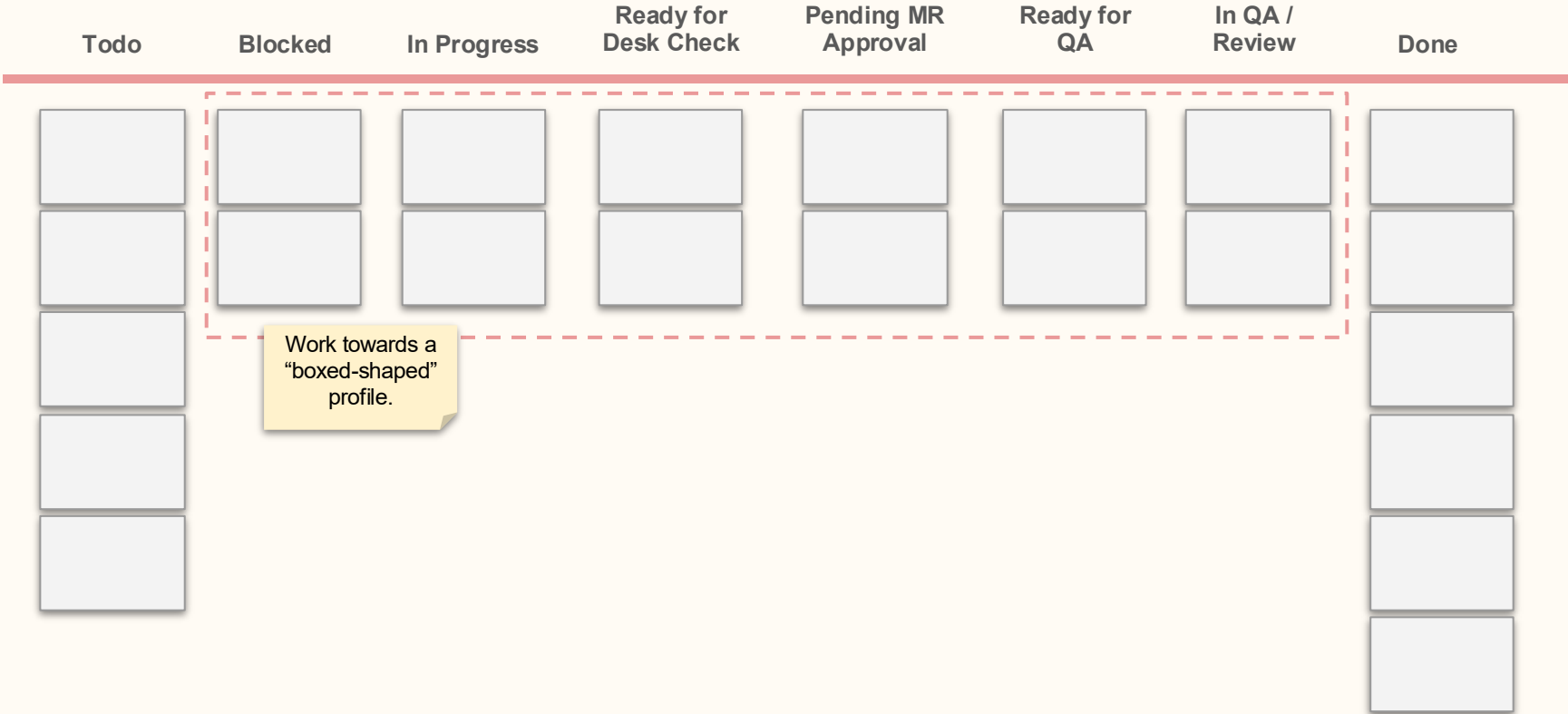
** May provide best balance between ease-of-use and practicality.*

Best Practices

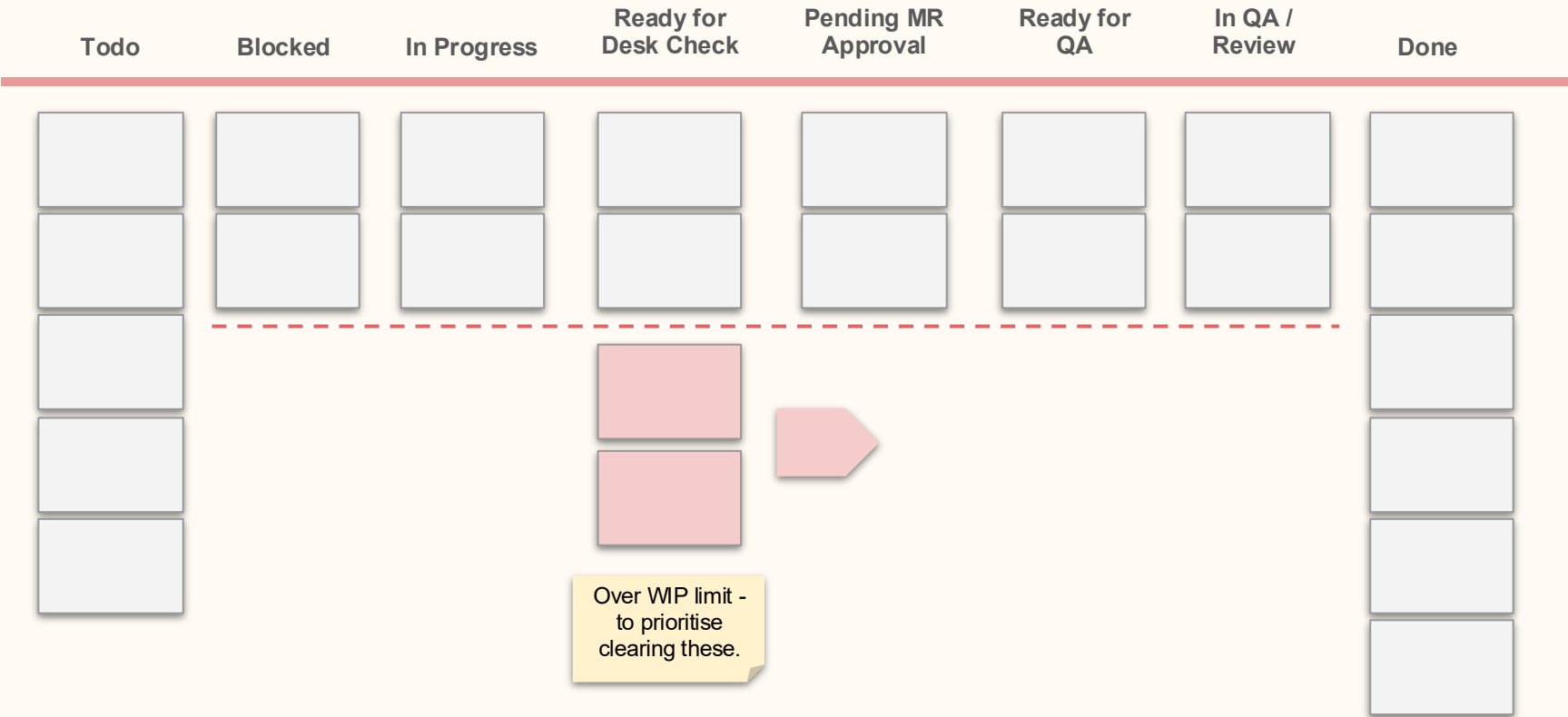
Lean Concepts > Kanban



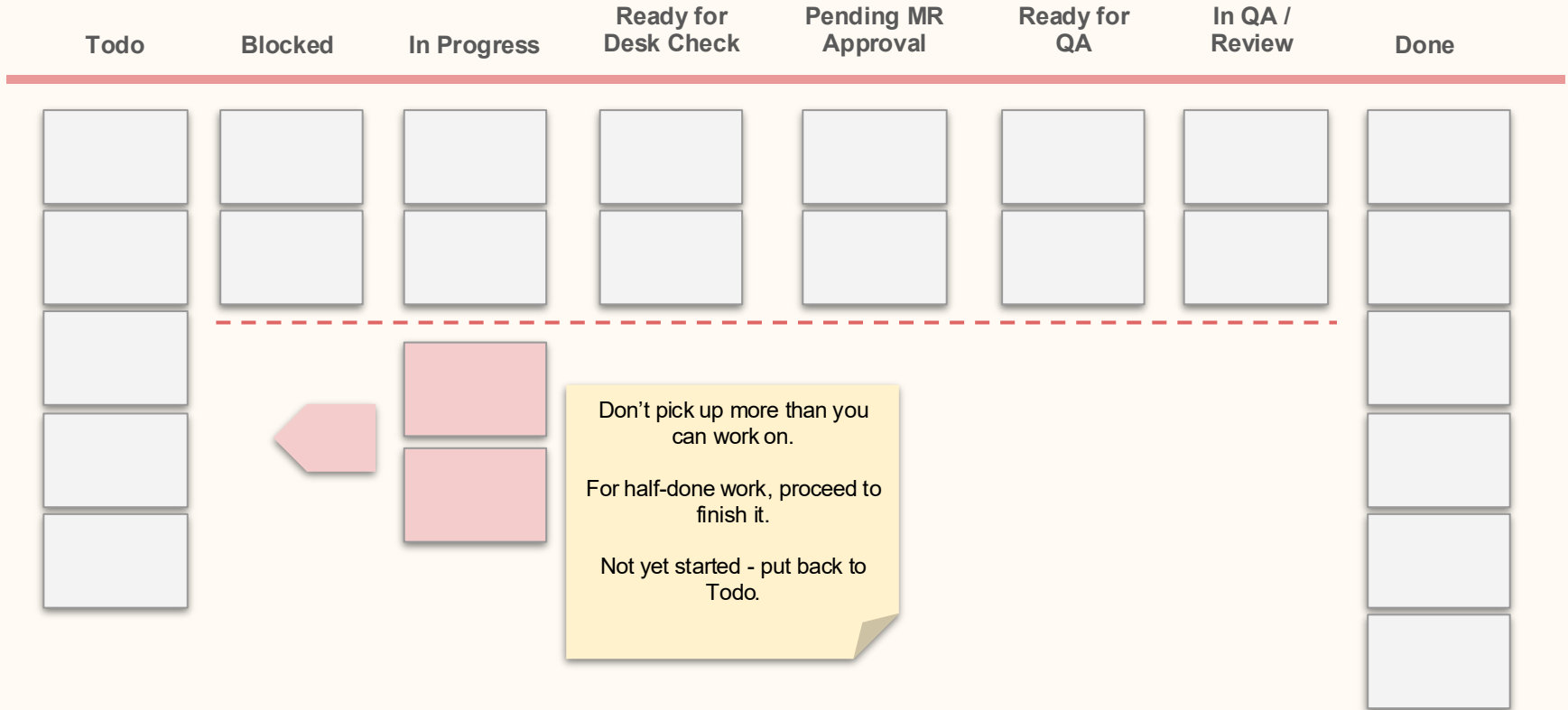
Lean Concepts > Kanban > WIP Limits



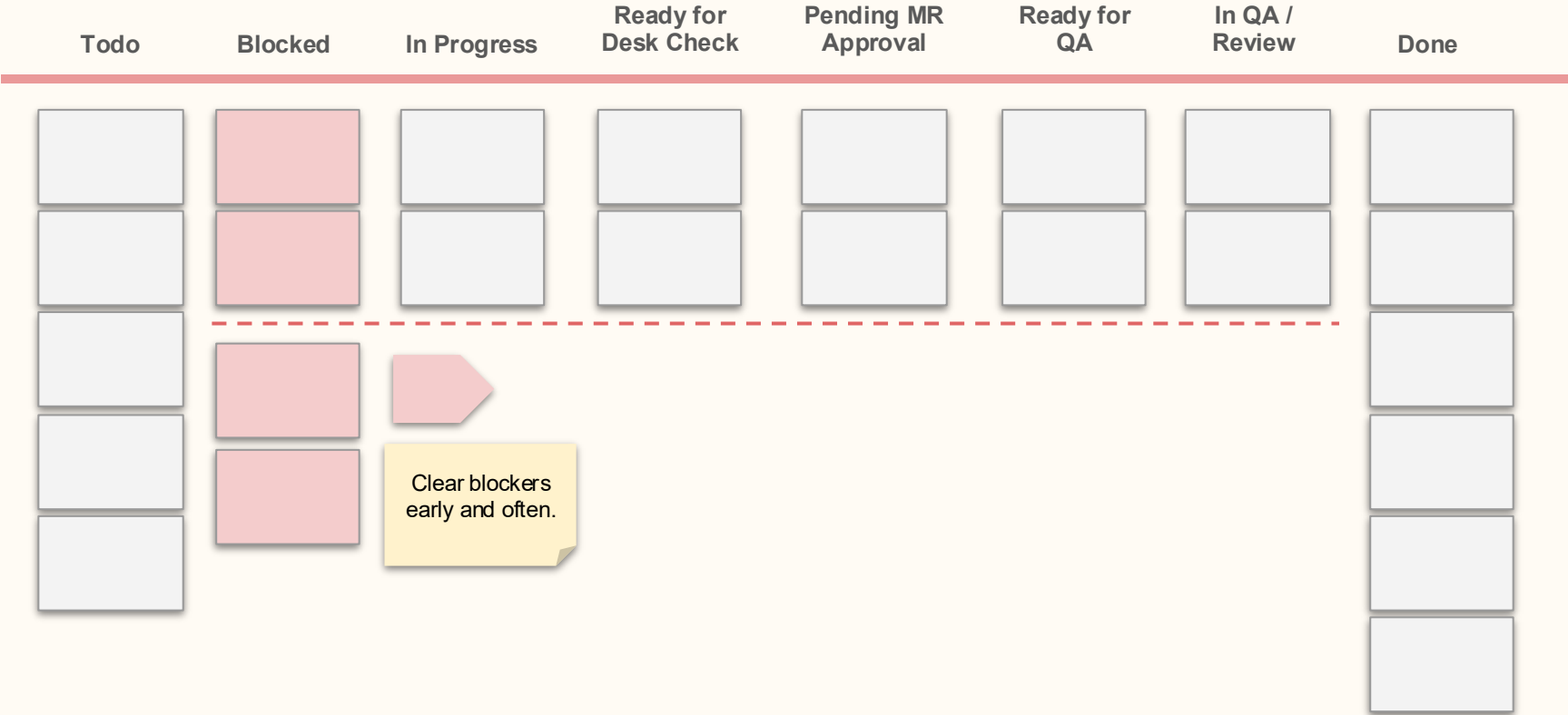
Lean Concepts > Kanban > Line Balancing



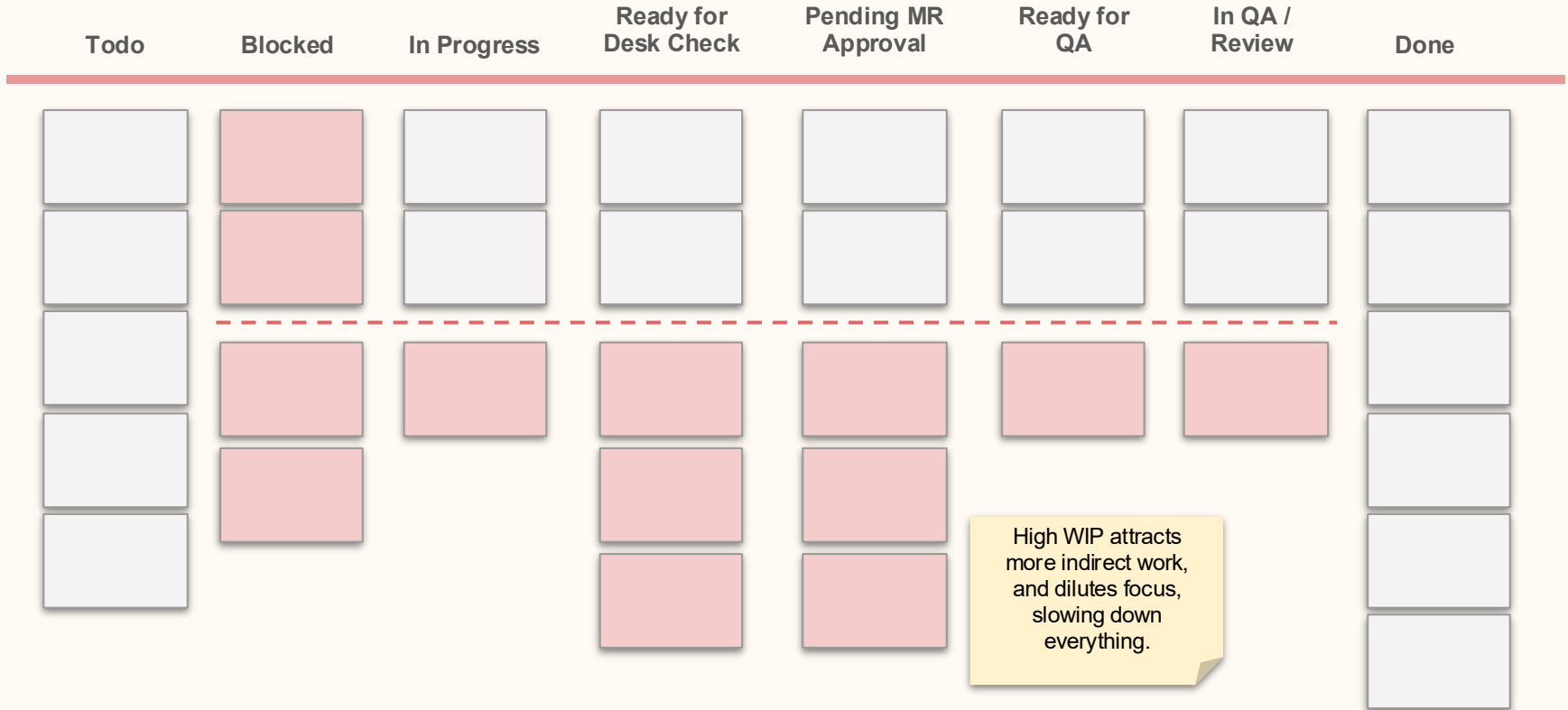
Lean Concepts > Kanban > “One Piece” Flow



Lean Concepts > Kanban > Clear Blockers Quickly



Lean Concepts > Kanban > Reduce Gravitational Pull

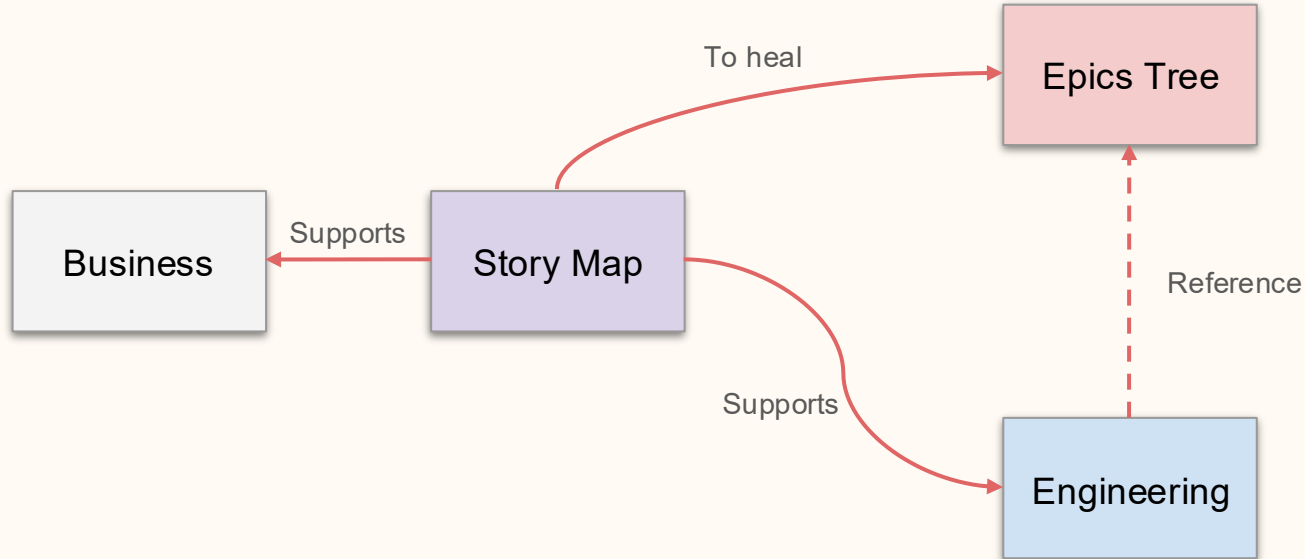


Lean Concepts > Kanban > When to Review/Intervene

- During the pre-sprint planning session.
- Ad Hoc (when there is available time).
- Post-Standup.
- During crunch time (i.e. nearing product launch).
- Methods - MoSCoW / RICE Scoring.

Inter-systems View

Mental Models > Scaffoldings (1 of 2)

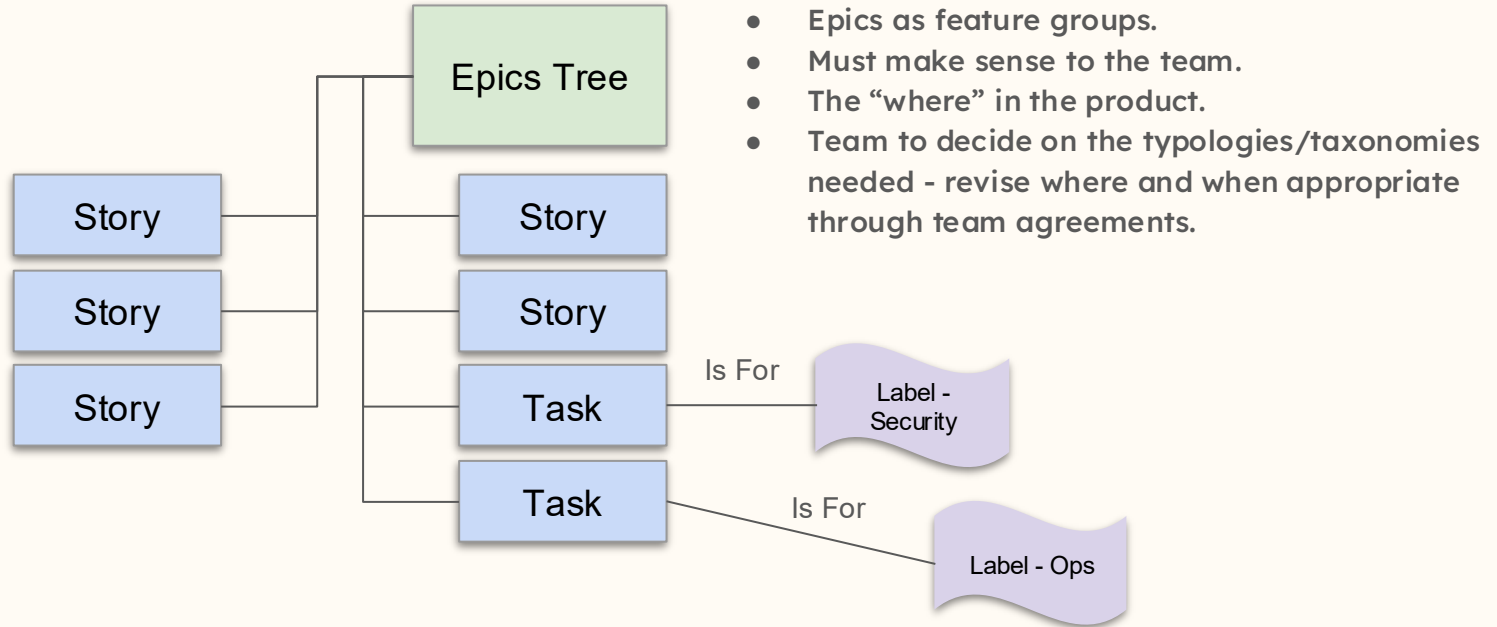


- Temporary structures to bridge work processes.
- Examples, sprint targets, story mapping, tech planning.

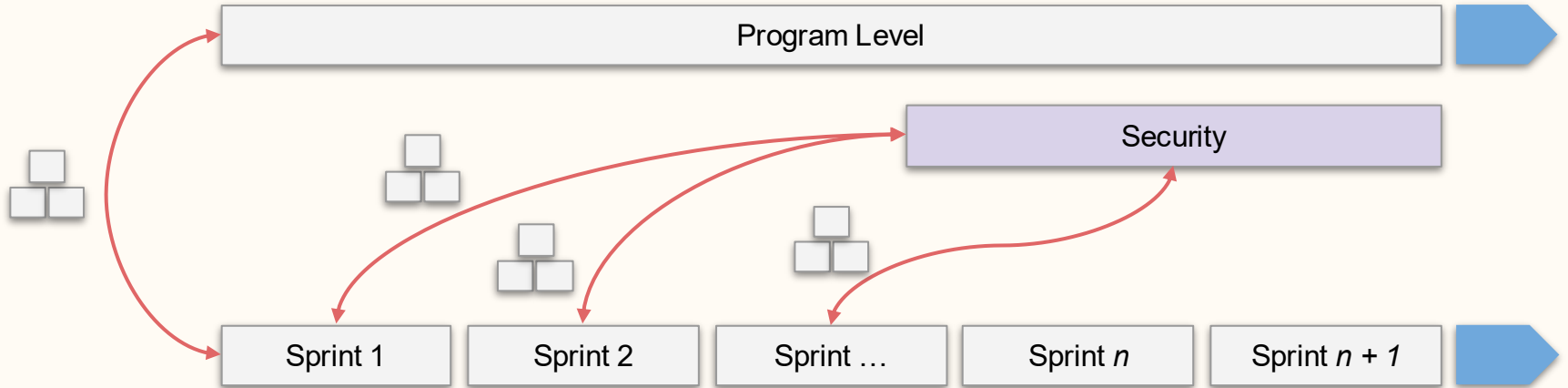
Mental Models > Scaffoldings (2 of 2)



Mental Models > Epics Tree



Mental Models > Feedback Loops



- Some feedback loops are longer, thus feedback may be delayed.
- In these situations, time is your best friend (i.e. create systems, working agreements, work structure, start earlier).



Work Items (i.e. Stories, Tasks, Bug Fixes etc.)

Other Guiding Principles

Other Guiding Principles

- Do what works (inspect / adapt along the way).
 - Where we are at - is just a starting point.
 - Imbue the team with a shared understanding to move forward.
- “Systems gardening” / Broken Window Theory (longer time arcs).
 - A well-manicured garden that changes organically over time.
 - Processes are just as important as outcomes.
 - See ahead, then work backwards.
- Take care of one another!

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